Freshman A+

ETHIOPIAN UNIVERSITY FRESHMAN EXAM PREP

LESSON-BY-LESSON NOTES

General Psychology

understand the mind · master the exam



PSYC 1011 · CHAPTERS 1 – 7

BIG IDEAS INSIDE

Sensation → Perception	CH 2
Classical & operant conditioning	CH 3
Encode → Store → Retrieve	CH 4
Maslow's hierarchy of needs	CH 5
Id · Ego · Superego	CH 6

1. **Every concept, made clear**
   Simple explanations, clear diagrams and comparison tables
2. **Real-life examples**
   Every theory shown in everyday situations, with hard questions solved step by step
3. **Real university exams**
   AAU · Arba Minch · Jimma · Bahir Dar · Wolaita Sodo · Mekelle and more, all with full solutions

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Essence of Psychology	Sensation & Perception	Learning	Memory & Forgetting	Motivation & Emotion	Personality	Disorders & Treatment

Based on the MoSHE **General Psychology** module (Psyc 1011)
With real exam questions from Ethiopian universities

Freshman A+ · Mujahid Tech

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Seven chapters · lesson-by-lesson notes, worked examples, exam traps, and university exam questions with full solutions.

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HOW EACH LESSON IS BUILT

KEY IDEA
The main point you must remember.

EXAM TRAP
Where students usually lose marks.

MEMORY AID
A short trick to recall lists and pairs.

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE
The idea seen in everyday Ethiopian life.

Question tags: University · Exam real past paper University · Model Exam prepared model question

CHAPTER

01

Essence of Psychology

Why does one student study late at night while another gives up after one bad result? Why do two people see the same event and remember it differently? **Psychology** tries to answer such questions scientifically. This chapter explains what psychology is, what it tries to achieve, where it came from, the different ways psychologists look at behaviour, the fields where they work, and the research methods they use. It is the foundation of the whole course and appears in every mid exam.

LESSONS IN THIS CHAPTER

1.1 What Psychology Is and Its Four Goals

1.2 Historical Background and the Early Schools

1.3 Modern Perspectives in Psychology

1.4 Branches (Sub-fields) of Psychology

1.5 Research Methods in Psychology

Freshman A+ · General Psychology (Psyc 1011)

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.1

What Psychology Is and Its Four Goals



AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define psychology and explain its three key terms
- Distinguish overt behaviour, covert behaviour and mental processes
- Explain the four goals of psychology with examples
- Identify the goal behind any research question

1.1.1 The meaning of psychology

The word comes from two Greek words: **psyche** (mind, soul or spirit) and **logos** (study, knowledge or discourse). So, in its early meaning, psychology was "the study of the soul". Because the soul cannot be seen, measured or tested, this definition is **no longer accepted**. Before psychology became a separate science, questions about the mind and soul were discussed under **philosophy**.

D THE MODERN DEFINITION

Psychology is the scientific study of behaviour and mental processes (of humans and animals).

Key term	Meaning	Examples
Scientific	uses systematic methods and **empirical** (observable, measurable) evidence, not common sense or personal opinion	experiments, surveys, systematic observation
Behaviour	**overt** actions and reactions that others can observe	talking, walking, laughing, writing, a child colouring a picture
Mental processes	**covert** (hidden, internal) activities of the mind	thinking, feeling, remembering, dreaming, planning in your head

★ OVERT VS COVERT, THE MOST TESTED DISTINCTION

Overt = outside, can be seen by others. **Covert** = hidden, inside the person. Covert behaviour is generally treated as a **mental process**.

The test: *could a camera record it?* Writing notes, answering a question aloud and laughing at a joke → **overt**. Comparing two theories in your head, a good feeling about yourself, an attitude toward others, remembering last Ramadan → **covert**.

◉ SAME STUDENT, BOTH SIDES

Hana sits in the library. Her pen moves across the page (**overt** behaviour). Inside, she is recalling the lecture, worrying about the exam and deciding what to read next (**mental processes**). Psychology studies both, and how they affect each other: her worry (mental) may make her stop writing (behaviour), and finishing a page (behaviour) may make her feel confident (mental).

Why psychology is a science: it uses **systematic, objective methods** and **empirical evidence**, and it values **critical thinking**. **Common sense** is not a value of psychology; common-sense ideas are often **contradicted** by empirical evidence (for example, "opposites attract" vs "birds of a feather flock together" cannot both be always true).

1.1.2 The four goals of psychology

THE FOUR GOALS: EACH ANSWERS ONE QUESTION

Goal	Question it answers	What it involves
Description	*What* is happening? Where? To whom? Under what circumstances?	observing and **recording** behaviour carefully
Explanation	*Why* is it happening?	finding the **causes**; helps build **theories**
Prediction	*What will happen* in the future?	forecasting behaviour from what is known
Control	*How can it be changed*?	**applying** psychological principles to change undesirable behaviour into desirable behaviour

THE MODULE'S FRESHMAN GIRL: ONE CASE, FOUR GOALS

- **Description:** a teacher notices that a freshman girl has stopped doing her homework, her results are slipping and her attitude to the course is negative.
- **Explanation:** after talking to her parents and friends, the teacher concludes that she behaves this way because she gets **attention** (a reward) when she behaves oddly.
- **Prediction:** based on research on similar cases, the counsellor predicts she **may never reach her full learning potential** if nothing changes.
- **Control:** the counsellor uses learning strategies (and stops rewarding the odd behaviour) so that she succeeds academically.

  "Control" also has a research meaning: holding a factor constant. When studying intelligence and academic performance, a psychologist **controls** family socio-economic status so it does not distort the result.

SOLVING A GOAL QUESTION (INJIBARA 2014)

"Why does Alemu always quarrel with his classmates? How can we change it? What will be the consequence? What is his behaviour?" Which question belongs to prediction?

Step 1: Match each question word to a goal: *Why* → explanation; *How can we change* → control; *What will be the consequence* → prediction; *What is his behaviour* → description.

Step 2: Prediction looks to the **future**, so the answer is **"What will be the consequence of Alemu's quarrelling behaviour?"**

Shortcut: look for **time** (future = prediction), **cause** (why = explanation), **change/intervention** (training, therapy, programme = control).

GOAL TRAPS

- "Smokers are **more likely** to develop lung cancer" → **prediction** (a forecast), not explanation.
- "The team won **because of** good preparation" → **explanation** (a cause).
- "Offering life-skills training to freshmen" or "arranging a programme based on findings" → **control** (applying knowledge to change behaviour).
- "Prediction focuses on changing undesirable behaviour" is **false**; that is control.

Exam Practice

15 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.1

1 Wachemo University · Mid 2014

Psychology is a science which studies only the behaviour of animals and human beings together with the mental processes of animals.

True / False

2 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

Which one of the following is no longer an acceptable definition of psychology?

A) Psychology is the study of animals' behaviour
B) Psychology is the study of overt actions
C) Psychology is the study of mental processes
D) Psychology is the study of the soul

3 Arsi University · Mid 2015

Which one of the following is the best example of overt behaviour?

A) Planning activities in your mind
B) Adding numbers in your mind
C) Thinking about this question
D) A two-year-old boy colouring a picture

4 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2014

Which of the following is NOT a mental process?

A) A good feeling about oneself
B) A good attitude towards others
C) Remembering a past event
D) Explaining a future plan (to others)

5 Arba Minch University · Mid 2016

Which of the following is an example of a mental process?

A) Answering questions in class
B) Taking lecture notes
C) Laughing at the instructor's joke
D) Comparing psychological perspectives

6 Haramaya University · Mid 2015

In the definition of psychology, the term "scientific" refers to:

A) the use of common sense
B) the use of empirical data
C) the study of internal covert activities
D) the study of overt actions

7 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

Which of the following does NOT reflect the values of psychology?

A) Empirical evidence
B) Critical thinking
C) Systematic research methods
D) Common sense

8 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2014

Which goal of psychology emphasizes the causes of human behaviour?

A) Prediction
B) Description
C) Control
D) Explanation

9 Arsi University · Mid 2015

"Findings show that smokers are more likely to develop lung cancer." This statement describes which goal of psychology?

A) Description
B) Control
C) Explanation
D) Prediction

10 Jimma University · Mid 2014

An Ethiopian football coach said the national team beat Egypt because of their good preparation. If a sport psychologist analyses this behaviour in terms of the goals of psychology, which goal is involved?

A) Description
B) Prediction
C) Control
D) Explanation

11 Dilla University · Mid 2015

Offering life-skills training to freshman students to improve their academic skills at university reflects which goal of psychology?

A) Prediction
B) Description
C) Explanation
D) Control

12 Injibara University · Mid 2014

A psychologist studied age differences in helping behaviour among Injibara town residents and found that older people helped more than younger people. Based on the findings, he arranged a programme to improve helping behaviour among the young. This programme reflects which goal?

A) Description
B) Explanation
C) Prediction
D) Control

13 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2014

A teacher attributes students' misbehaviour to their internal psychological problems. Which goal of psychology did the teacher apply?

A) Prediction
B) Control
C) Description
D) Explanation

14 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

Prediction is a goal of psychology that focuses on changing undesirable behaviours.

True / False

15 Arba Minch University · Mid 2017

Which statement best describes the relationship between behaviour and mental processes?

A) Behaviour is internal while mental processes are external
B) Mental processes alone shape behaviour
C) They are unrelated
D) Behaviour and mental processes are intertwined and influence each other

Answers & Explanations

1. False

Psychology studies the behaviour **and** mental processes of both humans and animals. The statement wrongly limits mental processes to animals.

2. D

Psychology is the study of the soul

"Study of the soul" is the old etymological meaning. The soul cannot be observed or measured, so it cannot be studied scientifically.

3. D

A two-year-old boy colouring a picture

Colouring can be seen by others. Planning, adding in your mind and thinking are covert mental processes.

4. D

Explaining a future plan (to others)

Explaining a plan aloud is an observable action (overt behaviour). Feelings, attitudes and memories are internal mental processes.

5. D

Comparing psychological perspectives

Comparing ideas happens inside the mind. Answering, writing and laughing are overt.

6. B

the use of empirical data

"Scientific" means using systematic procedures and empirical (observable, measurable) data. C and D describe mental processes and behaviour.

7. D

Common sense

Psychology relies on evidence and systematic methods; common sense is often contradicted by research.

8. D

Explanation

Explanation answers "why", i.e. it looks for causes.

9. D

Prediction

"More likely to develop" is a forecast about the future, so it is prediction.

10. D

Explanation

"Because of good preparation" gives a reason (cause) for the result: explanation.

11. D

Control

Training is an intervention that applies psychology to change behaviour, i.e. control.

12. D

Control

The study itself described the difference; arranging a programme to change behaviour is control.

13. D

Explanation

Attributing behaviour to a cause ("because of internal problems") is explanation.

14. False

Changing behaviour is control. Prediction forecasts what will happen.

15. D

Behaviour and mental processes are intertwined and influence each other

Thoughts and feelings affect actions, and actions affect thoughts and feelings (Hana's case in this lesson).

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.2

Historical Background and the Early Schools

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Explain how psychology became a science in 1879
- Describe the five early schools: founders, subject matter and methods
- Compare the schools by object, goal and method
- Recognise each school from a quotation or example

1.2.1 The birth of scientific psychology

Psychology is a young science. It became independent in **1879** when **Wilhelm Wundt** opened the **first psychology laboratory** at the **University of Leipzig, Germany**. He used **objective introspection** to study conscious experience scientifically, so he is called the **father of modern psychology**. His laboratory helped establish psychology as a **scientific discipline**, separate from philosophy.

D SCHOOL OF THOUGHT

A **system of thinking** that gives a general, organised way of explaining behaviour or the mind (for example, "behaviour is all inherited" vs "behaviour is all learned").

1.2.2 The five early schools

F THE FIVE EARLY SCHOOLS AT A GLANCE

School	Founder(s)	Psychology is the study of...	Key idea	Method
Structuralism	**Edward Titchener** (student of Wundt)	the **structure** (elements) of the conscious mind	break experience into **sensations, images and feelings**	**introspection** ("looking inward")
Functionalism	**William James** (first American psychologist, first psychology textbook)	the **function** (use) of the mind	the mind helps us **adapt** and survive; asks the **"why"** question	questionnaires, mental tests, objective descriptions of behaviour
Gestalt	**Max Wertheimer** (Germany)	the mind as a **whole**	"**the whole is greater than the sum of its parts**"; Gestalt = form, pattern, whole	studies of perception
Behaviourism	**John B. Watson**; also Thorndike, Skinner	**observable, measurable behaviour** only	the mind cannot be studied scientifically; all behaviour is **learned**; learners are passive; used **animals**	observation, experiments, conditioning
Psychoanalysis	**Sigmund Freud** (Vienna physician)	the **unconscious** mind	the mind is like an **iceberg**; hidden wishes and childhood conflicts drive behaviour	clinical case studies, hypnosis, **dream analysis**

HOW TO TELL THE SCHOOLS APART

They differ in three things:

1. **Object** of study: conscious mind (structuralism, functionalism, Gestalt), unconscious mind (psychoanalysis), or overt behaviour (behaviourism).
2. **Goal:** analyse the parts of the mind, explain its use, see it as a whole, or show how the environment shapes behaviour.
3. **Method:** introspection, mental tests and questionnaires, observation, clinical case studies.
   Memory line: Structuralism = **what** the mind is made of; Functionalism = **why/what for** the mind exists; Gestalt = the **whole** mind; Behaviourism = **no mind, only behaviour**; Psychoanalysis = the **hidden** mind.

EACH SCHOOL EXPLAINS SLEEP (ASTU 2015)

- **Functionalist:** "Sleep is an **adaptive** process; it kept humans out of harm's way at night." (purpose)
- **Psychoanalyst:** "Sleep is the royal road to the **unconscious**." (dreams reveal hidden wishes)
- **Behaviourist:** would measure observable sleep behaviour and what conditions reward it.
- **Structuralist:** would ask trained observers to report the sensations and feelings of becoming sleepy.

WATSON'S FAMOUS CLAIM

"Give me a dozen healthy infants ... and I'll guarantee to take any one at random and train him to become any type of specialist I might select: doctor, lawyer, even beggar-man and thief." This expresses behaviourism's belief that **environment and learning**, not heredity, shape behaviour. Watson also argued that we can no more define consciousness than define the soul, so it cannot be studied scientifically.

SCHOOL TRAPS

- **Wundt** founded the first laboratory; **Titchener** founded structuralism.
- **Introspection** was the method of the **structuralists** (and Wundt), not the functionalists; critics said it was too **subjective**.
- The **iceberg** comparison belongs to **Freud**.
- "We cannot define consciousness any better than we can define the soul" is **Watson** (behaviourism), not functionalism.
- **Behaviourism** is the only early school that did **not** study the inner, hidden experience; it shifted psychology's subject from **mind to observable behaviour** and led to the rise of **animal research**.
- Structuralism, functionalism and Gestalt can be summarised as the study of the **origin (elements), role (function) and wholeness** of mind.

Exam Practice

16 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.2

1 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2014

An early school of thought that used introspection to discover the elementary units of the mind is:

A) functionalism
B) structuralism
C) Gestalt
D) psychoanalysis

2 Arsi University · Mid 2015

The goal of structuralism was to find out the function of elements such as sensations, images and feelings.

True / False

3 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2015

Understanding the use of the mind is the focus of **__, while analysing conscious experience into mental elements is the focus of ____**.

A) Gestalt; structuralism
B) structuralism; functionalism
C) functionalism; behaviourism
D) functionalism; structuralism

4 Arba Minch University · Mid 2017

The early school of thought that focused on the "why" question is:

A) Structuralism
B) Psychoanalysis
C) Behaviourism
D) Functionalism

5 Jimma University · Mid 2015

"In order to study human behaviour, we must consider the whole of perception rather than its component parts." This statement would most likely be made by a follower of:

A) Functionalism
B) Structuralism
C) Behaviourism
D) Gestalt psychology

6 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

A leader wrote that we are weak when we act separately but very powerful when we are "added together". This idea supports:

A) Functionalism
B) Structuralism
C) Psychoanalysis
D) Gestalt psychology

7 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

Which school of psychology compared human mental experience to an iceberg?

A) Behaviourism
B) Structuralism
C) Humanistic psychology
D) Psychoanalysis

8 Dilla University · Mid 2015

As introspection is to structuralism, _____ is to psychoanalysis.

A) Mental tests
B) Questionnaires
C) Observation
D) Dream analysis

9 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

_____ is the approach that arose from the belief that the study of the mind and consciousness was not scientific.

A) Structuralism
B) Humanistic psychology
C) Psychoanalysis
D) Behaviourism

10 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2015

All of the following early schools focused on internal, invisible experience EXCEPT:

A) Functionalism
B) Gestalt psychology
C) Structuralism
D) Behaviourism

11 Dire Dawa University · Mid 2014

Which school of psychology was most responsible for the rise of animal research in psychology?

A) Structuralism
B) Psychoanalysis
C) Gestalt
D) Behaviourism

12 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

"Give me a baby, and I will make it grow into whatever I want." This claim is associated with:

A) B. F. Skinner
B) Wilhelm Wundt
C) Ivan Pavlov
D) John Watson

13 ASTU · Mid 2015

Which statement represents the early school of thought called functionalism?

A) Sleep clears useless information from our minds
B) Sleep is the royal road to the unconscious mind
C) Sleep is a time when the brain recovers from exhaustion and stress
D) Sleep is an adaptive process that kept humans out of harm's way

14 Arba Minch University · Mid 2017

How did the establishment of the first psychology laboratory contribute to psychology?

A) It led to the development of psychoanalysis
B) It marked the beginning of behaviourism
C) It proved that the mind could not be studied scientifically
D) It helped establish psychology as a scientific discipline

15 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

Functionalists are known for using the method of introspection.

True / False

16 Jimma University · Mid 2014

As William James is to functionalism, Wilhelm Wundt is to behaviourism.

True / False

Answers & Explanations

1. **B**

structuralism

Structuralists (Titchener) analysed conscious experience into sensations, images and feelings through introspection.

2. **False**

Structuralism looked for the **elements** (structure) of the mind. Studying the **function** of the mind was functionalism.

3. **D**

functionalism; structuralism

"Use" = function → functionalism; "elements" = structure → structuralism.

4. **D**

Functionalism

Functionalists asked why the mind works as it does, i.e. what it is for and how it helps us adapt.

5. **D**

Gestalt psychology

Gestalt psychology holds that the whole is greater than the sum of its parts.

6. **D**

Gestalt psychology

The whole (people together) is more than the sum of the parts (individuals): a Gestalt principle.

7. **D**

Psychoanalysis

Freud said conscious awareness is only the tip; the larger, hidden part is the unconscious.

8. **D**

Dream analysis

Freud used clinical case studies, hypnosis and dream analysis to reach the unconscious.

9. **D**

Behaviourism

Watson argued that consciousness cannot be located or measured, so psychology should study only observable behaviour.

10. **D**

Behaviourism

Behaviourism studied only observable, measurable behaviour.

11. **D**

Behaviourism

Watson focused on animal behaviour, and conditioning research (Pavlov's dogs, Skinner's rats and pigeons) followed.

12. **D**

John Watson

Watson's famous "dozen healthy infants" claim expresses the behaviourist belief that environment shapes everything.

13. **D**

Sleep is an adaptive process that kept humans out of harm's way

Functionalism explains mental processes by their adaptive purpose for survival.

14. **D**

It helped establish psychology as a scientific discipline

Wundt's 1879 Leipzig laboratory applied scientific methods to mental experience, separating psychology from philosophy.

15. **False**

Introspection is associated with Wundt and the structuralists. James used questionnaires, mental tests and objective descriptions.

16. **False**

Watson founded behaviourism. Wundt founded the first laboratory (and his student Titchener founded structuralism).

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.3

Modern Perspectives in Psychology



AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Describe the six modern perspectives and their key assumptions
- Link each modern perspective to the early school it grew from
- Explain why behaviourism is called the "black box" approach
- Apply the perspectives to explain the same behaviour

1.3.1 One behaviour, many explanations

The main lesson of the early schools: **the same behaviour can be explained in different ways**. So modern psychologists use several **perspectives** (views). Each asks different questions and gives a different kind of explanation.

THE SIX MODERN PERSPECTIVES

Perspective	Explains behaviour by...	Key words to spot
Psychodynamic (from Freud)	**unconscious** forces, inner conflicts, **childhood experiences**	unconscious, childhood, inner conflict, "archaeologists of the mind"
Behavioural (from Watson)	**learning** from the environment: rewards and punishments	environment, reward, punishment, conditioning, observable
Humanistic (Maslow, Rogers)	**free will**, personal values, **self-actualization** (reaching full potential)	free will, growth, uniqueness, potential, innately good
Cognitive	**mental processes**: thinking, reasoning, memory, problem solving, beliefs	thinking, reasoning, deciding, beliefs, expectations
Biological	the **brain**, nervous system, **hormones**, neurotransmitters, **genes**, evolution	brain chemistry, genes, twins, heredity, neurotransmitters
Socio-cultural	**social and cultural** context: groups, norms, culture, gender roles	culture, society, group, norms, "fish in water"

THE "BLACK BOX" APPROACH

The **behavioural** perspective treats the mind as a **black box**: it studies only what goes **in** (environmental stimulus) and what comes **out** (behaviour), not the processes inside. It is concerned with **how the environment affects** a person's actions.

WHY DID KEBEDE FAIL HIS EXAM? SIX ANSWERS

- **Psychodynamic:** an unconscious conflict, for example hidden resentment toward a strict father, made him avoid studying.
- **Behavioural:** studying was never rewarded, and watching football with friends was.
- **Humanistic:** he chose a department he did not value, so he lacked the motivation to grow.
- **Cognitive:** he believed "I am bad at mathematics", so he gave up quickly; he also used poor study strategies.
- **Biological:** lack of sleep and stress hormones impaired his memory.
- **Socio-cultural:** family duties in the countryside and peer norms ("studying hard is not cool") pulled him away from study.

! PERSPECTIVE TRAPS

- The **cognitive** perspective studies **covert behaviour** (mental processes); "as psychoanalysis is to the unconscious mind, the **cognitive** perspective is to covert behaviour".
- "**The child is the father of the man**" (childhood shapes the adult) = **psychodynamic**.
- Twins reared apart who turn out very similar = **biological** (genetic heritage).
- "**Behaviour is guided by free will**" belongs to the **humanistic** perspective, not the socio-cultural one.
- The **biological** perspective does **not** emphasize mental processes; that is the cognitive perspective.
- The socio-cultural perspective says behaviour **cannot** be understood without culture.

Exam Practice

13 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.3

1 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2014

As psychoanalysis is to the unconscious mind, _____ is to covert behaviour.

A) humanistic psychology
B) behaviourism
C) the socio-cultural perspective
D) the cognitive perspective

2 ASTU · Mid 2015

Why is behaviourism labelled the "black box" approach to psychology?

A) It gives little emphasis to overt behaviour
B) It gives much emphasis to mental processes
C) It focuses on the process rather than the input–output aspect of behaviour
D) It is concerned with how the environment affects the person's actions, not with what happens inside the mind

3 ASTU · Mid 2015

Which saying illustrates the psychoanalytic perspective?

A) The whole is different from the sum of its parts
B) We are born free and determine our destiny
C) The child is the father of the man
D) Environment is the carpenter of our behaviour

4 ASTU · Mid 2015

Researchers at the University of Minnesota studied identical twins separated at birth and reared in very different environments. Despite the different backgrounds, the twins were remarkably similar in personality and habits. This finding most strongly supports which perspective?

A) Behavioural
B) Socio-cultural
C) Humanistic
D) Biological

5 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

A researcher believes that all humans are innately good and have free will, and studies the factors that help people reach their fullest potential. This researcher is most likely a:

A) Cognitive psychologist
B) Behaviourist
C) Psychoanalyst
D) Humanistic psychologist

6 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

Dr. Salah often explains human behaviour in terms of people's ability to reason, think and decide. His approach fits which perspective?

A) Biological
B) Behavioural
C) Socio-cultural
D) Cognitive

7 Wachemo University · Mid 2016

Studying how neurotransmitters affect mood belongs to which perspective?

A) Biological
B) Humanistic
C) Cognitive
D) Socio-cultural

8 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2014

In Ethiopia, people living near regional borders are often bilingual and take part in the neighbouring region's dress, wedding and funeral customs. Their identity is best studied from which perspective?

A) Functionalism
B) Socio-cultural
C) Humanistic
D) Cognitive

9 Arba Minch University · Mid 2016

According to the socio-cultural perspective, which statement is FALSE?

A) Behaviour is guided by free will
B) Behaviour varies across societies
C) Gender roles influence behaviour
D) The social context shapes an individual's behaviour

10 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

Anger at one's mother, memories of childhood abuse and hatred of a family member would be emphasized by which perspective?

A) Socio-cultural
B) Psychoanalytic
C) Humanistic
D) Cognitive

11 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

A teacher tells his students that they will score "A" if they work very hard, and he rewards effort. His view is most similar to:

A) Behaviourism
B) The humanistic approach
C) The cognitive approach
D) Psychoanalysis

12 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

Among the modern perspectives, the biological perspective emphasizes the role of mental processes underlying behaviour.

True / False

13 Wachemo University · Mid 2015

Find the mismatch between a perspective and its assumption.

A) Socio-cultural perspective: focuses on individual free will and creed
B) Functionalism: what the mind does
C) Gestalt: the whole is greater than the sum of its parts
D) Behaviourism: observable and measurable behaviour must be studied

Answers & Explanations

1. D

the cognitive perspective

The cognitive perspective studies internal mental processes (covert behaviour) such as thinking and remembering. Behaviourism ignores covert behaviour.

2. D

It is concerned with how the environment affects the person's actions, not with what happens inside the mind

Behaviourists study input (stimulus) and output (behaviour) and treat the mind in between as an unopened box.

3. C

The child is the father of the man

Psychoanalysis stresses that childhood experiences shape adult personality. A = Gestalt; B = humanistic; D = behavioural.

4. D

Biological

The twins share the same genes but not the same environment, so their similarity points to genetic (biological) influence.

5. D

Humanistic psychologist

Innate goodness, free will and self-actualization are the core ideas of the humanistic perspective.

6. D

Cognitive

Reasoning, thinking and deciding are mental processes, the focus of the cognitive perspective.

7. A

Biological

Neurotransmitters are brain chemicals; the biological perspective studies how bodily processes affect behaviour and feelings.

8. B

Socio-cultural

Language, customs and group identity are cultural and social influences on behaviour.

9. A

Behaviour is guided by free will

Free will is the humanistic view. The socio-cultural view stresses social and cultural influences.

10. B

Psychoanalytic

Childhood experiences and hidden emotional conflicts are the material of the psychodynamic (psychoanalytic) perspective.

11. A

Behaviourism

Shaping behaviour through rewards for effort reflects the behavioural view that learning from consequences shapes behaviour.

12. False

Mental processes are the focus of the cognitive perspective. The biological perspective emphasizes the brain, hormones and genes.

13. A

Socio-cultural perspective: focuses on individual free will and creed

The socio-cultural perspective focuses on social and cultural context, not individual free will. B, C and D are correctly matched.

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.4

Branches (Sub-fields) of Psychology

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Describe the main branches of psychology
- Distinguish clinical, counselling, health and educational psychology
- Identify the branch from a case description

1.4.1 Where psychologists work

THE BRANCHES OF PSYCHOLOGY

Branch	Focus	Typical case
Developmental	physical, cognitive and psychological changes **across the life span** (womb to old age)	how children's thinking changes with age
Personality	relatively **enduring traits**; self-concept, aggression, moral development	why some people are outgoing and others shy
Social	social interaction, relationships, attitudes, **conformity**, group influence	why adolescents conform to their peers
Cross-cultural	the role of **culture**; compares processes **across cultures** (universal or culture-specific?)	sex-role socialization in Ethiopian vs Kenyan families
Industrial / organizational	psychology in the **workplace**: productivity, job fit, satisfaction	choosing the best person for a job
Forensic	psychology in the **legal system**: police, courts, eyewitness testimony	judging an eyewitness's reliability
Educational	improving **teaching, curriculum, administration** of academic programmes	designing better teaching methods
School	applying psychology in schools: **identifying learning difficulties**, helping individual students	assessing a child with reading problems
Health	prevention and treatment of **physical illness**	helping patients follow HIV medication
Clinical	prevention, diagnosis and treatment of **severe psychological disorders**	treating schizophrenia or severe depression
Counselling	**milder** personal, educational, vocational, marital problems	helping a freshman choose a department

THREE PAIRS EXAMINERS LIKE TO CONFUSE

- **Clinical vs counselling:** both help people with problems, but clinical deals with **severe disorders**; counselling deals with **milder, everyday** problems of normal people.
- **Clinical vs health:** clinical treats **psychological** disorders; health psychology deals with **physical** illness.
- **Educational vs school:** educational psychology improves the **whole educational process** (curriculum, teaching, administration); school psychology works with **individual students' learning difficulties** in schools.

MATCH THE CASE TO THE BRANCH

A soldier who lost his legs develops a serious psychological disorder → **clinical**. A student is unsure which department to choose → **counselling**. A court needs to know if a witness's memory can be trusted → **forensic**. A company wants to reduce employee absence → **industrial/organizational**. A researcher compares child-rearing in Ethiopia and Kenya → **cross-cultural**.

Exam Practice

11 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.4

1 Arsi University · Mid 2015

_____ deals with the application of psychological methods to legal questions.

A) Abnormal psychology
B) Forensic psychology
C) Sport psychology
D) Health psychology

2 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2014

A psychologist who assesses the characteristics of eyewitnesses in a court of justice works in which specialty?

A) Social
B) Counselling
C) Industrial
D) Forensic

3 Arsi University · Mid 2015

Which area studies differences in sex-role socialization between Ethiopian and Kenyan parents?

A) Social psychology
B) Cross-cultural psychology
C) Clinical psychology
D) Educational psychology

4 Arsi University · Mid 2015

Which branch deals with a soldier who lost his legs and now suffers from a psychological disorder?

A) Counselling psychology
B) Health psychology
C) Personality psychology
D) Clinical psychology

5 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2015

Counselling psychology is for mild emotional and personal problems; _____ is for the diagnosis and treatment of severe psychological problems.

A) Personality psychology
B) Clinical psychology
C) Health psychology
D) Social psychology

6 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

Mr. X studies what makes adolescents conform to the behaviour and opinions of other adolescents. His research best represents:

A) Social psychology
B) Cultural psychology
C) Developmental psychology
D) Personality psychology

7 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

A researcher interested in what makes an employee best suited for a given job would most likely be a(n) _____ psychologist.

A) Personality
B) Industrial and organizational
C) Clinical
D) Developmental

8 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

Which sub-field studies human changes from the womb to the end of life?

A) Developmental psychology
B) Clinical psychology
C) Counselling psychology
D) Health psychology

9 Arba Minch University · Mid 2016

A field of psychology that deals with identifying students' learning difficulties is:

A) educational
B) clinical
C) counselling
D) school

10 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

Clinical psychology applies psychological principles to the prevention and treatment of physical illness.

True / False

11 Mekelle University · Mid 2011

Psychologists who help normal people with minor educational, vocational, marital and health-related problems make better decisions belong to which field?

A) Clinical psychology
B) Developmental psychology
C) Social psychology
D) Counselling psychology

Answers & Explanations

1. **B**

Forensic psychology

Forensic psychology applies psychology to the legal system: police work, courts and testimony.

2. **D**

Forensic

Eyewitness testimony is a classic forensic topic.

3. **B**

Cross-cultural psychology

Comparing a psychological process across two cultures is cross-cultural psychology.

4. **D**

Clinical psychology

Diagnosing and treating a (severe) psychological disorder is clinical psychology.

5. **B**

Clinical psychology

Clinical psychology handles severe disorders.

6. A

Social psychology

Conformity and peer influence are central topics of social psychology.

7. B

Industrial and organizational

Matching people to jobs and improving productivity is industrial/organizational psychology.

8. A

Developmental psychology

Developmental psychology covers changes across the entire life span.

9. D

school

School psychologists assess and help individual students with learning difficulties. Educational psychology works on the educational process as a whole.

10. False

That is health psychology. Clinical psychology deals with psychological disorders.

11. D

Counselling psychology

Counselling psychologists help people with milder everyday problems.

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.5

Research Methods in Psychology



AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define scientific method, theory, hypothesis and variable
- Describe descriptive, correlational and experimental methods with their strengths and limits
- Identify independent, dependent and extraneous variables and experimental and control groups
- Interpret correlation coefficients and follow the five steps of research

1.5.1 Key terms

- **Scientific method:** testing ideas through **systematic observation, experimentation and statistical analysis**, reducing bias and error.
- **Theory:** an integrated set of principles that **describes and explains** observed facts.
- **Hypothesis:** a **tentative, testable** statement about the relationship between two or more variables. Example: "Children who watch violent cartoons will become more aggressive than those who watch non-violent cartoons."
- **Variable:** anything that can change or vary (test scores, sleep hours, gender, temperature).

1.5.2 Descriptive research

The researcher simply **records** what is observed. It mainly serves the goal of **description**.

THE THREE DESCRIPTIVE METHODS

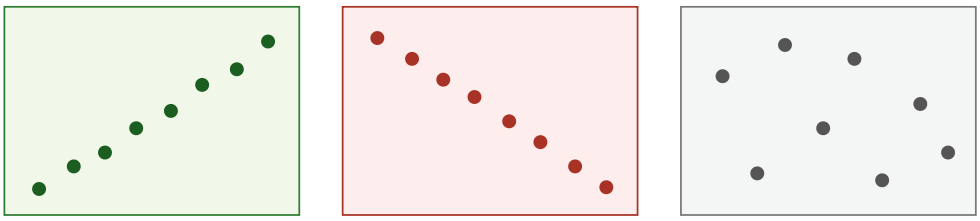
Method	What it is	Strength	Limitation
Naturalistic observation	watching behaviour in its **natural setting** without interfering	real, not artificial, behaviour	**observer effect** (people act differently when watched) and **observer bias** (seeing what you expect)
Case study	studying **one individual** (or a few) **in great depth**, including history	very rich data; good for **rare** problems	results **cannot be generalized** to others
Survey	questionnaires or interviews given to a **large group**	quick data from many people; good for **private (covert)** behaviour, attitudes and opinions	needs a **representative sample**; people may not answer honestly

1.5.3 Correlational research

Measures the **relationship** between two or more variables, e.g. smoking and life expectancy, or stress and work overload. It shows **whether** variables are related, **how strongly**, and in **what direction**, but it **cannot prove cause and effect**. It does allow **prediction**.

READING A CORRELATION COEFFICIENT (R)

- r ranges from **−1.00 to +1.00**. A value like +1.30 is **impossible**.
- **Sign = direction.** Positive (+): both variables move **together** (both up or both down). Negative (−): they move in **opposite** directions (one up, the other down).
- **Size = strength.** The closer to **1** (ignoring the sign), the stronger. **0** = no relationship.
- So **−0.96 is stronger than +0.92**, and **0.01 is weaker than −0.02**.



Scatter plots for positive, negative and zero correlation

CORRELATION IS NOT CAUSATION

A negative correlation between wealth and psychological disorders means **poorer people are more likely** to have a disorder. It does **not** tell us whether poverty causes disorders, disorders cause poverty, or a third factor causes both. Likewise "students who watch more TV get lower grades" (correct description of a negative correlation) is different from "TV causes poor grades" (a causal claim correlation cannot prove).

1.5.4 Experimental research

The only method that can show **cause and effect**. The researcher **manipulates** one factor and holds all others constant.

THE PARTS OF AN EXPERIMENT

Term	Meaning	Memory trick
Independent variable (IV)	the factor the researcher **manipulates** or applies (the presumed **cause**)	what *I* change
Dependent variable (DV)	the behaviour **measured** (the **effect**); it *depends* on the IV	what I measure
Extraneous (confounding) variable	any **other** factor that could affect the DV and must be controlled	the uninvited guest
Experimental group	receives the **treatment** (the IV)	gets the "special" condition
Control group	treated **exactly the same except** for the IV; gives a **baseline** for comparison	gets "nothing" or the usual condition
Random assignment	placing participants in groups by chance so the groups are equal at the start	

SOLVING AN EXPERIMENT QUESTION STEP BY STEP (DILLA 2015)

"A researcher wants to know the effect of coffee on students' attention span. He takes 40 freshmen with similar backgrounds and randomly divides them into two groups. G1 drinks two cups of coffee; G2 drinks none. Then attention span is measured." Identify the design, DV, IV and groups.

Step 1, **design:** a factor is manipulated and participants are randomly assigned → **experimental** design.

Step 2, **IV:** what the researcher gives or changes → **coffee consumption**.
Step 3, **DV:** what is measured → **attention span**.
Step 4, **groups:** G1 receives the treatment → **experimental group**; G2 does not → **control group**.
Step 5, **extraneous variables** to control: hours of sleep, other drinks, time of day.
Rule: In "the effect of **X** on **Y**", X is the IV and Y is the DV.

SPOT THE VARIABLES

- "The effect of altitude on athletes' performance": IV = altitude; DV = **performance**.
- "Exposure to corporal punishment leads to aggression": IV = corporal punishment; DV = **aggression**.
- "The impact of khat chewing on the academic achievement of Wolaita Sodo students": IV = khat; DV = achievement; a possible **extraneous** variable = **coffee** (another stimulant).
- "Exposure to light decreases depressive symptoms": IV = **light**; DV = depressive symptoms.

EXPERIMENT TRAPS

- The **experimental** group receives the IV; it is the **control** group that gets everything except the IV.
- Experimental and control groups are equal in **every** way **except** the treatment, not in every way.
- Correlation can **predict** but cannot explain causes; only experiments show causation.
- Correlation is **not** a descriptive method (descriptive = observation, case study, survey).

1.5.5 Steps of scientific research

1. **Defining the problem:** noticing something that needs explaining (children seem more aggressive after violent cartoons).
2. **Formulating the hypothesis:** an educated, testable guess.
3. **Testing the hypothesis:** choosing a method and **collecting data** to accept or reject it.
4. **Drawing conclusions:** generalizing from the results.
5. **Reporting the results:** writing what was done and found so others can learn, replicate and apply it.

"PEOPLE HATE TESTING DRY REPORTS"

Problem → **H**ypothesis → **T**est → **D**raw conclusions → **R**eport.

Exam Practice

23 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.5

1 Arsi University · Mid 2015

Which research method permits conclusions about cause and effect?

A) Experimental method
B) Descriptive method
C) Correlational method
D) Naturalistic observation

2 Arsi University · Mid 2015

In a study of "the effect of altitude on athletes' performance level", performance level is the _____ variable.

A) independent
B) dependent
C) extraneous
D) control

3 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2014

Hypothesis: "Exposure to corporal punishment is more likely to lead to aggression." Aggression is the **__ and exposure to corporal punishment is the ____**.

A) confounding variable; independent variable
B) independent variable; dependent variable
C) independent variable; confounding variable
D) dependent variable; independent variable

4 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

A psychologist plans an experiment on "the impact of khat chewing on the academic achievement of Wolaita Sodo University students". Which could be a potential extraneous variable?

A) Khat
B) Students
C) Academic achievement
D) Coffee

5 Jigjiga University · Mid 2012

To learn the effect of light on productivity, an experimenter exposed Group A workers to light and Group B workers to a no-light condition. Which statement is correct?

A) Group B is the control group
B) Light is the dependent variable
C) Productivity is an extraneous variable
D) Group A is the control group

6 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

What does a control group provide in an experiment?

A) The group in which variables are manipulated
B) Participants who receive random treatment
C) Results used for statistical correction
D) A baseline for comparison with the experimental group

7 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

In an experiment, the experimental group is exposed to all aspects of the treatment except the independent variable.

True / False

8 Mekelle University · Mid 2016

Correlational research identifies both the relationship and the cause-and-effect between variables.

True / False

9 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2013

To understand the unusual behaviour of an adult client, a clinical psychologist carefully investigates the client's current life situation and physical, socio-cultural and educational history. Which method is being used?

A) Case study
B) Survey
C) Experimentation
D) Naturalistic observation

10 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

Which research method is most suitable for studying rare behaviours or problems?

A) Survey
B) Case study
C) Experiment
D) Correlation

11 Haramaya University · Mid 2015

A researcher wants to document the prevalence of COVID-19 across Ethiopia. Which type of research fits best?

A) Case study
B) Experimental research
C) Correlational research
D) Survey research

12 Ambo University · Mid 2014

Melaku wants to study the relationship between psychological distress and work overload. Which research method fits?

A) Case study
B) Survey
C) Correlation
D) Experiment

13 Jimma University · Mid 2015

A researcher watches nursery-school children during the day and records every instance of helping behaviour as it occurs, without intervening. The researcher is using:

A) the experimental method
B) naturalistic observation
C) case studies
D) the survey method

14 Arsi University · Mid 2015

Which pairing of a research method and its limitation is NOT correct?

A) Case study: inability to generalize
B) Experimental research: observer bias
C) Survey research: difficulty getting a representative sample
D) Correlational research: inability to show negative relationships

15 Arba Minch University · Mid 2013

Which of the following correlation coefficients indicates the strongest relationship?

A) −0.96
B) +0.92
C) 0.00
D) +1.30

16 Jigjiga University · Mid 2014

Which of the following correlation coefficients shows the weakest relationship?

A) −0.02
B) 0.88
C) −0.97
D) 0.01

17 Addis Ababa University · Mid 2013

A negative correlation between degree of wealth and the likelihood of suffering from a psychological disorder would indicate that:

A) poverty makes people more vulnerable to psychological disorders
B) people who are poor are more likely to have a psychological disorder than wealthy people
C) psychological disorders cause poverty
D) wealth and disorders are unrelated

18 Addis Ababa Science and Technology University · Mid 2015

Which statement best illustrates a negative correlation between hours of TV watched the week before an exam and the exam grade?

A) Watching too much TV leads to poor exam performance
B) Smart students watch less TV
C) TV interferes with preparing for exams
D) Students who watch more TV tend to score lower on the exam

19 Mekelle University · Mid 2016

Which of the following is NOT a descriptive method?

A) Case study
B) Naturalistic observation
C) Correlation
D) Survey

20 Arsi University · Mid 2015

At which research step does the researcher collect data to accept or reject the hypothesis?

A) Defining the problem
B) Testing the hypothesis
C) Formulating the hypothesis
D) Drawing conclusions

21 Injibara University · Mid 2014

A psychologist randomly assigned adolescents to two groups. Group one watched TikTok videos for five consecutive days; group two did not. Then their behaviour was compared. Which is correct?

A) DV = adolescents' behaviour; IV = watching TikTok; control group = group two; experimental group = group one
B) DV = watching TikTok; IV = adolescents' behaviour; control group = group two; experimental group = group one
C) DV = adolescents' behaviour; IV = watching TikTok; control group = group one; experimental group = group two
D) DV = watching TikTok; IV = adolescents' behaviour; control group = group one; experimental group = group two

22 Dire Dawa University · Mid 2014

For the study "the effects of watching football games on school performance", identify (a) the independent variable, (b) the dependent variable, (c) the experimental group, (d) the control group.

23 Model question (module discussion)

A psychologist explores the effect of tutorial support on students' academic performance. Group one gets tutorial support; group two does not. Name the IV, DV, experimental group and control group, and suggest two extraneous variables.

Answers & Explanations

1. **A**

Experimental method

Only experiments manipulate an independent variable while controlling other factors.

2. **B**

dependent

Performance is what is measured; it depends on altitude (the IV).

3. D

dependent variable; independent variable

The presumed cause (punishment) is the IV; the outcome measured (aggression) is the DV.

4. D

Coffee

Khat is the IV and achievement the DV. Coffee, another stimulant, could also affect achievement and must be controlled.

5. A

Group B is the control group

Group B does not receive the treatment, so it is the control (baseline). Light is the IV and productivity the DV.

6. D

A baseline for comparison with the experimental group

The control group is treated identically except for the IV, so differences can be attributed to the IV.

7. False

That describes the **control** group. The experimental group receives the independent variable.

8. False

Correlation shows relationships (and allows prediction) but cannot prove causation.

9. A

Case study

An in-depth investigation of one individual, including history, is a case study.

10. B

Case study

Rare cases are too few for surveys or experiments; a case study examines them in depth.

11. D

Survey research

Prevalence across a whole country requires collecting data from a very large sample: a survey.

12. C

Correlation

The word "relationship" between two measured variables signals correlational research.

13. B

naturalistic observation

Observing behaviour in its natural setting without interfering is naturalistic observation.

14. D

Correlational research: inability to show negative relationships

Correlation can show negative relationships (negative r). Its real limitation is that it cannot show causation.

15. A

−0.96

Strength depends on size, not sign: 0.96 > 0.92. +1.30 is impossible because r cannot exceed 1.

16. **D**

0.01

0.01 is closest to zero.

17. **B**

people who are poor are more likely to have a psychological disorder than wealthy people

Negative: as wealth goes down, disorders go up. A and C are causal claims that correlation cannot support.

18. **D**

Students who watch more TV tend to score lower on the exam

Only D describes the relationship without claiming a cause.

19. **C**

Correlation

Correlational research is a separate type that measures relationships between variables.

20. **B**

Testing the hypothesis

Data collection happens in the testing step.

21. **A**

DV = adolescents' behaviour; IV = watching TikTok; control group = group two; experimental group = group one

The manipulated factor (TikTok) is the IV, the measured outcome (behaviour) is the DV, and the group that watched is the experimental group.

22. **(a) Watching football games; (b) School performance; (c) Students who watch football; (d) Students who do not watch football**

"The effect of X on Y": X (watching football) is manipulated and Y (school performance) is measured. The group exposed to X is experimental; the other is the control.

23. **IV = tutorial support; DV = academic performance; experimental = group one; control = group two**

Possible extraneous variables include students' prior achievement, study hours, class attendance, and the quality of different instructors. Random assignment and holding these constant control them.

CHAPTER 1 · QUICK REVISION

Essence of Psychology — at a glance

CHAPTER 1 AT A GLANCE

Topic	Must-know points
Definition	scientific study of **behaviour** (overt) and **mental processes** (covert)
Goals	describe (what), explain (why), predict (what will happen), control (how to change)
Birth	1879, Wundt, Leipzig, first laboratory, introspection
Early schools	structuralism (Titchener, elements, introspection); functionalism (James, function, adaptation); Gestalt (Wertheimer, whole); behaviourism (Watson, observable behaviour); psychoanalysis (Freud, unconscious, iceberg)
Modern perspectives	psychodynamic, behavioural (black box), humanistic (free will), cognitive (mental processes), biological (brain, genes), socio-cultural (culture)
Branches	clinical (severe), counselling (mild), health (physical illness), forensic (law), I/O (work), educational vs school, developmental (life span), social, cross-cultural
Research	descriptive (observation, case study, survey); correlational (relationship, r from −1 to +1, no causation); experimental (IV manipulated, DV measured, control group = baseline)
Steps	problem → hypothesis → test → conclusion → report

THE FIVE EARLY SCHOOLS IN ONE SENTENCE

"**S**ome **F**riends **G**ot **B**ored **P**laying": **S**tructuralism (parts), **F**unctionalism (purpose), **G**estalt (whole), **B**ehaviourism (behaviour only), **P**sychoanalysis (unconscious).